



1ST WEEK: **DAY 1**

Getting acquainted

YOUR BABY TODAY

In the first 24 hours, your baby should pass urine and meconium, the first black, sticky feces, that are made up of waste products and bile. You'll be changing plenty of diapers, and in no time you'll be a diapering pro.

“ Finally, your baby is in your arms! As you recuperate, you'll get to know the baby you've waited to meet. ”

You may feel love at first sight, when you first hold your baby after the birth, but for many women, bonding takes place over the next few days or weeks. For both parents, skin-to-skin contact with your baby helps the bonding process and is particularly beneficial for premature babies (see [How you can help your baby](#)).

Try not to be anxious when you pick up your baby. In the first few weeks, your baby has little head control, so support them with a hand under their head and shoulders, or both hands under their arms and with your fingers supporting their head.

The nurses in the maternity ward are there for help and support. You'll be asked if you've urinated and will be offered help with breastfeeding if needed. A lactation consultant will likely also be on hand to guide you through the initial difficulties you may encounter. If your hospital offers “rooming in,” you'll get to spend most of the day with your baby present, except when the nurses take them for routine testing or the staff pediatricians exam them. You'll also be visited by the doctor every day that you're in the hospital so they can check on your progress.

SAFE SLEEPING

Crib death is a concern for all new parents. Follow these guidelines to minimize risks:

- **Put your baby on their back** to sleep.
- **Don't let your baby get too hot.** If it's chilly, add layers and cover their feet, but don't go overboard. In the summer, they may be comfortable sleeping in just a onesie—but make sure the fan or air-conditioning vent isn't directly overhead.
- **Don't let anyone smoke** around your baby.
- **Never sleep with** your baby on a sofa or armchair.
- **The safest place** for your baby to sleep is in a crib or co-sleeper near where you sleep. If you bring the baby into your bed to breastfeed, put them back in their crib or co-sleeper when done.
- **Keep all soft objects**, like pillows, toys, blankets, and loose bedding, out of the baby's crib. A firm mattress covered by a fitted sheet is best.